

involved in the game back then, all we have are fond memories of those days; or for women like Mary Grace Smith of Maryland, shelves full of collectible premium toys. Smith started collecting advertising premiums after she attended a presentation that discussed antiques and collectibles. When she returned home from the meeting, she noticed the Blue Bonnet Sue doll offer on the back of her margarine box. Enthused by the presentation she'd just witnessed, she sent for it, and the collection was launched. It wasn't long before she noticed all the refund premium offers in her Sunday coupon inserts. By the time she had obtained fifteen or twenty advertising toys through the mail, she began organizing her collection on a spreadsheet, noting dates, premium offers, and even copying the original refund form. When she and her husband moved in 2003, they packed up several display cases and nearly 200 collectible "toys" to go along with them. Smith especially liked premiums unique to the product; the Tidy Cat, the Raid Bug, the Kodak Colorkin stuffed animals, and the Fischer Sandwich Mouse, to name a few. My personal favorites were the Energizer Bunny premiums, a series of Rudolph reindeers with glowing noses from the Duracell Company, and Del Monte vegetable and fruit-themed "Yumkin" stuffed animals and Christmas ornaments that adorn my tree to this day. My children have fond memories of all the soccer balls, baseballs, toy cars, and shirts emblazoned with candy bar decals.